

to what is happening for e.g. the seat would need to tilt as the trainee pilot banks the plane and so on.

Go over the scenario and you'll realise that all that happened was augmentation. We took conditions from the real world such as altitude and wind-speed related information and plugged them into the simulation. We enhanced the experience by providing the right type of seat. We added the change in view as the plane would tilt. Virtual reality might not seem all that different.

Virtual Reality and Augmented Reality - difference

All lines between virtual reality and augmented reality are not blurred and hazy, There are certain stark differences:

- 1 Virtual reality can be built around places that do not exist. While we gave an example of Prototype which has been set in Manhattan, there are a plenty of games which are set in totally unreal locations and there is no way you could connect those places to reality. On the other hand, AR is not connected to non-existent worlds. All places on which AR would work (both theoretically and practically) have to exist.
- 2 Virtual reality requires certain setup which allows the experience to be immersive. The concept of VR revolves around building an experience so immersive that the subject (okay, we all hate being subjects, makes us sound like lab rats, but that is how you would find it written in a lot of literature concerning VR) forgets that he is not in the real world and perceives the virtual world as reality instead. Setup usually needs tools built for this purpose such as special glasses, large screens and other wearable gadgets that detect your movements and predict what you are trying to do in the virtual world. AR does not need all that. The concept of AR revolves around enhancing the reality that already exists by adding meaningful information to it.
- 3 Usage of AR almost always requires you to be present at the place where surroundings have to be to augmented.

One of the simpler ways to differentiate between VR and AR is that VR is about 'experiencing' a place whether or not it is real. AR is about 'enhancing' the perspective of a place by adding more information to it. All other differences creep in due to the differences in main idea around which they revolve. 